

Conversation

#23

CONVERSATION

MISSED CONNECTION – STRESS AT THE AIRPORT

Prepare 8 pieces of paper numbered from 1 to 4 and have each student draw one to discover their character.

This activity focuses on **money conversations, boundaries, negotiation, and emotional control.**

It's **early evening** at **Guarulhos International Airport (GRU).**

Four people are involved in a **missed connection situation** after a delayed flight.

The connection time was extremely short.

Gate information changed multiple times.

Now, boarding is almost closed — or already closed.

Passengers are stressed, information is unclear, and **decisions must be made fast.**

Situation Details

Detail	Situation
Connection time	35 minutes
Delay on first flight	28 minutes
Gate changes	2 changes
Boarding status	Closing / closed
Next available flight	Next morning
Available seats tonight	Only one

Student Coaching – How to Act

- Interrupt naturally
- Show frustration, urgency, confusion
- Ask direct questions
- Negotiate, complain, insist
- Don't sound "too polite" all the time — be real

Characters

1. Alex – The Stressed Passenger

"This is unbelievable.

We were told the connection time was enough.

Nobody gave us clear information.

First one gate, then another.

I can't miss this flight.

Staying overnight is not an option for me."

2. Rachel – The Airline Desk Agent

“I understand you’re upset — I really do.
But I don’t control delays or gate changes.
I’m trying to help everyone here.
Information is coming in real time.
Please let me check what options are still available.”

3. Mike – The Calm but Firm Passenger

“I’m frustrated too, but shouting won’t solve this.
We need clear answers.
If the connection is missed, what are our rights?
Rebooking? Hotel? Food voucher?
We just want transparency.”

4. Brian – The Airport Supervisor

“I’ve been called because the situation escalated.
Let me be clear and honest.
The gate is officially closed.
There is one seat left on the last flight tonight.
Company policy limits what we can offer.
We need to decide quickly.”

Guide your writing:

- Length: 80–120 words

Tone: realistic and personal

Title: _____